



**Class 10<sup>th</sup> | English**



# **First Flight**

**GLIMPSES OF INDIA**

**LECTURE - 2**

## QUESTIONS

1. What type of a text is 'A Baker from Goa'?
  - (a) A factual essay on past practices.
  - (b) A diary entry about one's life events.
  - (c) A research article which analyses a concept.
  - (d) A historical account written based on personal knowledge.

## QUESTIONS

**Ans.** (d) A historical account written based on personal knowledge.



## QUESTIONS

**2. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.**

"Our elders are often heard reminiscing nostalgically about those good old Portuguese days, the Portuguese and their famous loaves of bread. Those eaters might have vanished but the makers are still there. We still have amongst us the mixers, the moulders and those who bake the loaves. Those age-old, time-tested furnaces still exist. The fire in these furnaces has not yet been extinguished. The thud and jingle of traditional baker's bamboo, heralding his arrival in the morning; can still be heard in some places."

Hlw

## QUESTIONS

- i. Select the option that displays the reason why the narrator says that the furnaces were 'time-tested'.
- (a) They had been thoroughly tested each time, before being used
  - (b) They had proved the test of time and were working well
  - (c) They had been tested by modern day experts
  - (d) They had the power to withstand inexperienced usage

## QUESTIONS

**Ans.** (b) They had proved the test of time and were working well

## QUESTIONS

ii. "Those eaters might have vanished but the makers are still there."

Pick the option that expresses the tone of the narrator in the above statement.

- (a) elated and morose
- (b) critical and accusatory
- (c) hopeful and nostalgic

## QUESTIONS

**Ans.** (c) The author's tone is nostalgic for the Portuguese loaves of bread and at the same time hopeful that these bread and the Portuguese bakers exist in Goa.

## QUESTIONS

**iii.** What does the 'fire in the furnaces has not yet been extinguished' imply?

**Ans.** The 'fire in the furnace has yet not been extinguished' implies that the furnaces are still being used to bake the famous loaves of Portuguese bread.



## QUESTIONS

**iv.** Why did the baker come in with 'a thud and a jingle'?

**Ans.** The baker came with 'a thud and jingle' because he wanted to make people aware that he had come around to sell his breads.



## QUESTIONS

### 3. Read the following extract carefully and answer the questions that follow.

In our childhood we saw bakers wearing a shirt and trousers which were shorter than full-length ones and longer than half pants. Even today, anyone who wears a half pant which reaches just below the knees invites the comment that he is dressed like a Pader!

The baker usually collected his bills at the end of the month. Monthly accounts used to be recorded on some wall in pencil. Baking was indeed a profitable profession in the old days. The baker and his family never starved. He, his family and his servants always looked happy and prosperous. Their plump physique was an open testimony to this. Even today any person with a jackfruit-like physical appearance is easily compared to a baker.



## QUESTIONS

- i. "Monthly accounts used to be recorded on some wall in pencil" Which of these best explains the author's purpose for using some wall in the above line?
- (a) To convey that bakers were very organised in their job.
  - (b) To show that bakers were not very worried about their incomes.
  - (c) To indicate that bakers had more customers than they could service.
  - (d) To show that bakers were not too advanced in the systems they used.

## QUESTIONS

**Ans.** (b) To show that bakers were not very worried about their incomes.

## QUESTIONS

**ii.** Why did the author choose 'A Baker from Goa' as the title of the text?

**Ans.** The author chose 'A Baker from Goa' as the title of the text because he uses the life of a baker to trace the vivid history of the Goan villages that links them to the Portuguese people. Furthermore, the baker is also a perfect character to describe the beautiful culinary culture of the Goan villages.

## QUESTIONS

- iii. "The author mainly focuses on the physical appearance of the baker in the above extract." Which of these lines best explains the author's purpose for using 'physical appearance' in the above line?
- (a) The baker and his family never starved.
  - (b) The baker usually collected his bills at the end of the month.
  - (c) He, his family and his servants always looked happy and prosperous.

## QUESTIONS

**Ans.** (a) The baker and his family never starved.

## QUESTIONS

**iv.** What is the meaning of the phrase 'open testimony'?

**Ans.** The phrase 'open testimony' means a public statement proving a specific point.



## QUESTIONS

4. 'A Baker from Goa' is a nostalgic saga of childhood memories. Comment.

**Ans.** The author creates a sense of nostalgia in the story by describing several scenes of his childhood with a joyful tone. The passages describing the daily routine of the author with the routine arrival of the baker create a beautiful scene while making it clear that the author would love to go back to this simpler time which was full of joy.



## QUESTIONS

5. The relationship between the writer's family and the baker was a very commercial one. Do you agree? Justify your response.

**Ans.** No, it is not true to say that the relationship between the writer's family and the baker was a very commercial one.

According to the narrator, the baker used to be their friend, companion and guide.  
He focuses on the baker being on an informal basis with them.

## QUESTIONS

**6.** How did the baker become synonymous with celebrations and occasions in Goa?

**Ans.** The baker became synonymous with celebrations and occasions in Goa because his baked goods were a must during all the festivities. An engagement party was incomplete without sandwiches, the bread for which was supplied by the baker. Similarly, cake and bolinhas were required for Christmas and other festivals.

## QUESTIONS

**7.** How is the Goan baker still an important part of the life of a Goan village?

**Ans.** The baker is still an important part as he carried on the old Portuguese traditions and delivered bread for daily consumption. He supplied 'bol' for marriage festivities and cakes and 'bolinhas' during Christmas and other celebrations.

## QUESTIONS

- 8.** Describe any two aspects of the Goan lifestyle which show Portuguese influence. Support each aspect with evidence from the text.

**Ans.** The following are the two aspects of Goan lifestyle which portray Portuguese influence

1. The importance of the village baker in the rituals and culture of the Goan villages.
2. The prevalence of the short pants which were traditionally worn by the bakers, as well as the association it carries to being called a baker by the citizens of Goan villages.

## QUESTIONS

**9.** How do we know that bakers were an integral part of Goan society?

**Ans.** The baker's furnace was essential in a traditional Goan Village because different kinds of breads were required for different occasions. Marriage gifts are meaningless without the sweet bread known as bol. The lady of the house must prepare sandwiches on the occasion of her daughter's engagement. Cakes and bolinhas are essential for Christmas as well as other festivals.



## QUESTIONS

**10.** Why were the children fascinated by the baker?  
How did they show their eagerness to see him?

**Ans.** The children, according to the narrator, were eager to see the Goan baker. They used to wake up as soon as they heard the jingling sound of the bakers's bamboo stick. Whenever the baker greeted the lady of the house, children would surround the baker who would rebuke them and hand over the loaves to a servant. Then, the children would climb over a chair to peep into the basket full of bread loaves. These children didn't even brush their teeth before taking the bread bangles that they could choose carefully. Their actions made it clear that they were fascinated by the baker and were always eager to see him.

## QUESTIONS

**11.** "During our childhood in Goa, the baker used to be our friend, companion and guide." What does this statement tell us about the character of the baker?

**Ans.** The given statement tells us that the baker was a very respected person in the Goan society. He would guide children about good behaviour. This happened when he mildly scolded them for peeping into his basket. He taught children about giving respect to elders. This was when he wished 'Good Morning' to the lady of the house. He was very informal with the children. So, the narrator considered him a friend and companion. He was not simply a vendor interested in selling what he made. Even though he scolded the children, he offered them bread bangles and sweet bread of their choice. A party or feast lost its charm without bread. Cakes and bolinhas were a must for Christmas and other festivals. The presence of the baker's furnace in the village was absolutely essential. Thus, he was an important character in the Goan society of those days.



## QUESTIONS

**12.** How does the author establish that the pader is an important part of Goan society?

**Ans.** It is true to say that the traditional baker or pader and his bread play a significant role in the cultural and social fabric of Goan society.

The author establishes this by linking the importance of baked goods to various cultural festivals and celebrations around the Goan villages. The author mentions that any wedding gift is incomplete without the sweet bread known as 'bol'. Further, it is necessary for the lady of the house to make sandwiches on the occasion of the daughter's engagement. The celebrations of festivals like Christmas are believed to be incomplete without cakes and 'bolinhas'. Thus, the baker is very important in a Goan village.

## QUESTIONS

**13.** In the chapter, 'A Baker from Goa' the narrator talks about his childhood in Goa and his fond memories.

Compare the childhood of Nelson Mandela with that of the narrator.

**Ans.** South Africa and India are two vastly different countries. As such, it is expected that the experiences of the people that reside in these different geographical locations would also be different. But childhood is a blissful time period no matter where one lives. The innocence of childhood grants a specific innocence that makes children unaware of the harsh realities of their surroundings.

The experiences of both Nelson Mandela and Lucio Rodrigues were coloured by that same innocence.

Neither Rodrigues nor Mandela were aware of the changes taking place within their hometowns. They had a happy, carefree childhood full of 'freedom'.

## QUESTIONS

Rodrigues mentions the happy days of his youth where he would leave brushing his teeth in favour of eating the sweet bread-bangles brought by the Pader. Mandela also mentions his happy childhood where he believed that as long as he followed the rules of his father and his tribe, he had all the freedom he liked.

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## QUESTIONS

**14.** Why is Coorg called the land of rolling hills?

**Ans.** Coorg is called the land of rolling hills because it is situated on the gentle sloping hills that are covered with lush green rainforests. The hills on which it is located seem to be rolling down to a beautiful panoramic view which make it look like a piece of heaven on Earth.



## QUESTIONS

**15.** Where is Coorg located? Write any two characteristics of the people of Coorg?

**Ans.** Coorg is located midway between Mysore and the coastal town of Mangalore. The two main characteristics of the people of Coorg are that they are very hospitable and extremely brave.

## QUESTIONS

- 16.** Coorgis belong to a valorous and hospitable race.  
Comment on this statement with reference to the text.

**Ans.** Coorgis are said to belong to a valourous and hospitable race as their homes have tradition of hospitality. There are innumerable tales of courage related to the people belonging to Coorg. In fact, the Coorg Regiment is one of the most decorated in the Indian Army, and the first Chief of the Indian Army, General Cariappa, was a Coorgi. Even now, Kodavus are the only people in India permitted to carry firearms without a licence.



## QUESTIONS

**17.** What are the various stories regarding the origin of Kodavu people?

**Ans.** The two stories regarding the descent of Kodavu people are

- (i) Kodavus are of Greek origin. A part of Alexander's army settled here and married among the locals. Their descendants are called Kodavus.
- (ii) Kodavus are of Arab origin. They wear the same traditional dress Kuppia i.e. a long, black coat with embroidered waist belt, as the Kuffia of the Arabs and the Kurds.

## QUESTIONS

**18.** The Coorgis are the descendants of the Greeks or the Arabs and are still able to maintain their traditional practices. Do you agree that following these practices today is important? Why or why not?

**Ans.** After reading the text, I feel that it is important to follow the traditional practices. The reason is that it has kept the tradition of Coorgis known to the people even today. If the people of Coorg had not followed it, their tradition would have perished. Nobody would have remembered them today without their culture and traditional practices. According to the text, their traditions can be seen in the martial forms, religious rites and marriages. The Kodavus even wear the dress which resembles the dress of Arabs. Traditional practices also play a very important role in maintaining values amongst people.

## QUESTIONS

They have an impact on shaping the behaviour of people. These practices bind us together in our social life. Just like the Kodavus who are bound to their ancestors even today, we are also bound to our ancestors because of the traditional values we have inherited from them.

## QUESTIONS

**19.** The people of Coorg have a tradition of courage and bravery. How has it been recognised in modern India?

**Ans.** It is believed that the people of Coorg are descended from soldiers of the Greek army of Alexander the Great. Thus, the residents of Coorg have a culture of bravery and courage.

This is recognised by the following facts in modern India

- (i) The Coorg regiment is one of the most decorated regiment in the Indian army.
- (ii) The first Chief of the Indian army was a Coorgi-General Cariappa.
- (iii) Kodavus are the only people in India who are permitted to carry firearms without licence.



## QUESTIONS

**20.** Rajvir was very fond of reading detective stories.  
Why did he not like to read then during his journey?

**Ans.** Rajvir did not read detective stories during his journey because at that moment he wanted to keep looking at the beautiful scenery. It was green everywhere-soft paddy fields and then came tea bushes. It was a magnificent view for Rajvir to see greenery as far as his eyes could see.



## QUESTIONS

**21.** What is the Indian legend about the discovery of tea?

**Ans.** The Indian legend about the discovery of tea revolves around a Buddhist ascetic - Bodhidharma. He grew troubled by the fact that he felt sleepy during meditations. Therefore, he decided to cut-off his eyelids in an attempt to stop being sleepy. It is believed that ten tea plants grew out of those eyelids he cut off. The tea made from the leaves of these plants had the ability to banish sleep.

## QUESTIONS

**22.** Rajvir did his study before his visit to the tea plantation. Is it good to do one's research before the start of a new venture or does it take away from the thrill of discovery? Elucidate your stance.

**Ans.** The fact that Rajvir did his study before his visit to the tea plantation and his knowledge about the land he was visiting shows that it is good to do research before starting a new venture.

By doing so, not only does one get an idea about the destination but one can also plan the journey accordingly. One can also identify places or activities of interest. It does not take one away from the thrill of discovery, instead it helps in planning a better holiday.

## QUESTIONS

**23.** What did Pranjol and Rajvir do during the journey? Why?

**Ans.** During their journey to Dhekiabari, Pranjol was reading a detective book. In contrast, Rajiv was mesmerised with the views of the passing tea gardens. They had differing reactions because Pranjol was born in Assam and therefore, he was used to the sight of tea estates.

Meanwhile, Rajvir had never seen tea gardens in his life therefore, he was completely engrossed in looking at the beautiful green views. Later, Pranjol and Rajvir drank tea and discussed the legends surrounding the discovery of tea. They were drawn to this topic due to the fact that everyone around them was drinking tea as well.

## QUESTIONS

- 24.** Pranjol and Rajvir discuss their next vacation destination. They shortlist Coorg and Goa. Rajvir is keen on Coorg and tries to convince Pranjol. Develop a conversation between the two, based on your understanding of Glimpses of India.

You may begin like this

**Rajvir** Hey Pranjol! I think we should be visiting Coorg. It is a beautiful place with coffee plantations. I can smell the aroma already!

**Pranjol** I gave you the opportunity to explore a tea plantation last year, in Assam; I want to...





## QUESTIONS

**Ans. Rajvir** Hey Pranjol, let's visit Coorg for our next vacation.

It is a beautiful place between Mysore and Mangalore.

It is home to evergreen rainforests and coffee plantations. You know how much I love coffee.

**Pranjol** I have already fulfilled one such wish when we visited the tea plantations in Assam last year. I don't want to visit forests this time; rather I am more interested in a beach. So, let's go to Goa specifically North Goa.

**Rajvir** Okay, but there is lot more to Coorg than just coffee. Due to the rainforests there, there is a substantial number of animal species that can be found there. The place also provides opportunity for various adventure sports like river rafting, canoeing, rock climbing, etc. Not just this, the place has a very rich history as it is believed that the people there are of Greek or Arabic descent, and are extremely polite and hospitable. Even the river Kaveri has its roots there, with a wide variety of aquatic life.



## QUESTIONS

**Pranjol** That sounds interesting but I want to get away from the crowd and the hustle, and relax in some serene moments. And a few beaches in Goa would give me just that. Also, nothing calms like the ocean.

**Rajvir** Well, if you're looking for some calm then look no further than the Brahmagiri hills. We can climb it and at the end of that journey lies a beautiful landscape of Coorg. I read that the place even has the largest Tibetan settlement, near Bylakuppe. I am sure there will be much calm and spirituality in that place.

**Pranjol** I must say that you've done a great research about the place. And you've convinced me. Let's leave on this Friday.

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